

TOP TRICKS — NOTRUMP

1NT — Pass — 3NT — all pass. Final contract is 3NT (declarer needs 9 tricks).

Teaching feature: NS holds all 4 aces (in either hand) AND exactly 9 quick tricks on top. We assume outside entries exist, so split chains DO count (e.g., AK opposite Qxx = 3 QT). The per-suit count is capped by the longer single-hand length in that suit (so AK opposite Qx = 2 QT, since no hand has 3 cards in the suit).

Responder is constrained to no 4-card major (so no Stayman) and no 5-card major (so no transfer). The auction stays natural 1NT—3NT.

Things to think about:

- Count your top tricks before touching the hand.
- Chain rule: A, then K (anywhere in NS), then Q, then J, then T.
- Length cap: split chains need length in the longer hand to materialize.

Reference:

<https://www.bridgebum.com/counting.php>